Miguel Ángel **Castillo-Reina**

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About me

Economist and PhD student in Regional Science and Economic Geography at the Gran Sasso Science Institute (GSSI), with a Master's degree in Economics and extensive experience in teaching, research, consulting, and public policy development, with a strong focus on science, technology, and innovation (STI). Recognized as 'Junior Researcher' by the Ministry of Science, Technology, and Innovation (Colombia).

Proven leadership, communication, and project management skills, with substantial experience in drafting technical reports and policy documents. A highly motivated and dedicated professional, adept at applying economic analysis to social issues, performing well under pressure, and committed to continuous learning with strong attention to detail.

Education

Gran Sasso Science Institute (GSSI)

L'Aquila, Italy

PhD Regional Science and Economic Geography — *Nov. 2025 - Present*

- Student. Cohort XLI.
- Doctoral supervisors: Prof. Maria Giovanna Brandano and Prof. Alessandra Faggian.

Universidad Pedagógica y Tecnológica de Colombia (UPTC)

Tunja, Colombia

Master's in Economics — *2021*

- Merit Thesis (Honors Equivalent): *"Puentes y escaleras como caminos. El «desarrollo» y el capital social en el municipio de Gachantivá en Boyacá, 2020".*

Universidad Pedagógica y Tecnológica de Colombia (UPTC)

Tunja, Colombia

B.A. in Economics — *2016*

- Teaching Assistant – Macroeconomics (July 2014 – August 2016).

Experience

Ministry of Science, Technology, and Innovation (MINCIENCIAS)

Bogotá, Colombia

Contractor – Specialist in Regional Implementation of Science, Technology, and Innovation Policies — *Jul. 2023 - Oct. 2025*

- Contributed to the design and implementation of localized Science, Technology, and Innovation (STI) policies; supported regional capacity building in knowledge production, technology development, and innovation. Participated in the development of publicly funded research grant mechanisms and designed context-sensitive data collection methodologies.

Universidad de La Sabana

Chía, Colombia

Co-Principal Investigator — *May. 2023 - Oct. 2024*

- Co-Principal Investigator for the BPIN Project No. 2021000100459 «*Strengthening the Capacities of Actors within the Science, Technology, and Innovation Ecosystem to Promote R&D&I Projects that Contribute to the Development of the Department of Casanare*». Total project funding: COP 2,819,758,209 (~USD 850,000).

Organization of Ibero-American States for Education, Science and Culture (OEI)

Bogotá, Colombia

Contractor – Specialist in Regional Implementation of Science, Technology, and Innovation Policies — *Mar. - Jun. 2023*

- Responsible for supporting the design and implementation of strategies for the regional deployment of Science, Technology, and Innovation (STI) public policies for the Ministry of Science, Technology, and Innovation.

Fundación Universitaria de San Gil (UNISANGIL) *Yopal, Colombia*

Research Director – Yopal Campus *Aug. 2021 – Feb. 2023*

- Led the implementation and coordination of the university's research policy. Oversaw the formulation, management, and execution of research projects funded through the Science, Technology, and Innovation (STI) allocation of the General System of Royalties (SGR).
- General Coordinator of BPIN Project No. 2020000100435: *"Strengthening Information Systems for Water Quality and Environmental Services Assessment to Support the Sustainable Development of the Agro-Industrial Sector in the Department of Casanare (Yopal–Nunchía)".* Total project funding: COP 9,294,013,056 (~USD 2,256,296).

Organization of Ibero-American States for Education, Science and Culture (OEI) *Yopal, Colombia*

Regional STI Policy Advisor *Feb. - Sept. 2022*

- Specialized Professional in the formulation of public policy guidelines for Science, Technology, and Innovation (STI) in the departments of Arauca and Casanare, in alignment with CONPES 4069. Responsible for regional engagement and the identification of key actors and initiatives in the STI ecosystem.

Regional Center for Productivity and Innovation Management of Boyacá (CREPIB) *Tunja, Colombia*

Project Researcher *Feb. 2021 – Feb. 2022*

- Served as a researcher for the project funded by the Ministry of Science, Technology, and Innovation: *"Strengthening Production, Marketing, and Management Conditions of the Yellow Dragon Fruit Value Chain in the Municipality of Miraflores (Boyacá)"*.

Universidad Pedagógica y Tecnológica de Colombia (UPTC) *Tunja, Colombia*

Adjunct Lecturer and Project Researcher *Jun. 2020 – May 2021*

- Lectured in Microeconomics and Economics at the undergraduate level.
- Served as a researcher for the project *"Interpretation of Knowledge Transfer and Appropriation Processes of Traditional and Scientific Knowledge in Tourism Territories."*

Regional Center for Productivity and Innovation Management of Boyacá (CREPIB) *Tunja, Colombia*

Project Researcher *Apr. - Nov. 2019*

- Researcher contributing to the design and formulation of the Public Policy on Science, Technology, and Innovation for the Municipality of Tunja. This initiative was carried out in collaboration with the Special Administrative Unit for Science, Technology, and Innovation of Tunja (UMCITI) and the Regional Center for Productivity and Innovation Management of Boyacá (CREPIB).

Universidad Pedagógica y Tecnológica de Colombia (UPTC) *Tunja, Colombia*

Early-Career Researcher *Feb. 2018 – Nov. 2019*

- Junior researcher for the project *"The Alternative Market as a Development Option for the Alto Ricaurte Province in the Department of Boyacá."*
- Junior researcher for the project *"Towards the Development of Innovation Processes in the Tourism Sector of Alto Ricaurte (Boyacá) through Design Thinking."*
- Leader of the Emerging Research Group at CREPIB, focused on early-stage research training and project development.

Regional Center for Productivity and Innovation Management of Boyacá (CREPIB) *Tunja, Colombia*

Research Assistant *Sep. 2016 - Mar. 2018*

- Researcher within the operations of CREPIB as the technical operator of the Regional Labor Market Observatory of Boyacá. Responsibilities included the preparation of technical documents, development of indicators, and production of policy bulletins.
- Research Assistant for the project *"Assessment of the Current State of the Labor Market in the Department of Boyacá".*
- Key responsibilities included preparing technical documents, developing labor market indicators, and conducting workshops across the provinces of Boyacá. This project was part of the Regional Labor Market Observatory (ORMET Boyacá) and carried out in collaboration with the Ministry of Labor and the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP).

Publications

Books

1. **(2021)**. Dueñas, D., Vianchá, Z., Fraile, A., Castillo-Reina, M., et al. *Alternativas y potencialidades de valor agregado en iniciativas turísticas de tipo comunitario. Lecciones a partir del caso de la subprovincia del Alto Ricaurte (Boyacá).* Editorial UPTC. https://doi.org/10.19053/9789586605380

Book Chapters

1. **(2023)**. Castillo-Reina, M. & Pico, C. ¿Quiénes tienen el poder? La formación y la tecnocracia de economistas colombianos. In I. Silva Neira & A. Lambertini (Eds.), *Economia en crisis. La enseñanza de la economia en Latinoamérica y los límites de la teoría ortodoxa.* (1st ed., pp. 54-91). Rethinking Economics. https://bit.ly/DAS_EconCrisis

2. **(2020)**. Castillo-Reina, M. & Tobasura, E. Boyacá: a la penumbra de las oportunidades. In H.E. González & Ó. A. Alarcón (Eds.), *Boyacá Siglo XXI: dinámicas de desarrollo y competitividad regional*. (1st ed., pp. 247-273). Bogotá, Colombia: Universidad Antonio Nariño.

3. **(2019)**. Corredor, F. & Castillo-Reina, M. La enseñanza de la Economía: política, ideología y mercado. In J.I. González & M. Pérez (Eds.), *Mercados y bienestar: ensayos en memoria de Homero Cuevas.* (1st ed., pp. 81-118). Bogotá, Colombia: Universidad Externado de Colombia. https://bdigital.uexternado.edu.co/handle/001/2873

Articles in peer-reviewed journals

1. **(2023)**. Castillo-Reina, M., Pérez, N. & Ruiz, I. Yellow pitahaya (Selenicereus megalanthus) in Miraflores, Boyacá, Colombia. A social capital approach in a producer organisation. *Acta Agronómica, 71 (4).* https://doi.org/10.15446/acag.v71n4.100152

2. **(2021)**. Castillo-Reina, M. & Cruz-Vásquez, J. Tourist Sector Innovation: An Approach to the Services and the Co-Creation of Experiences. *Turismo & Sociedad (30)*, 25-49. https://doi.org/10.18601/01207555.n30.02

Working Papers

1. **(2026)**. Castillo-Reina, M. & Niño-Amézquita, J. *The territory and the development: 40 years of Sergio Boisier's thinking.* Submitted to Journal of the History of Economic Thought.

2. **(2021)**. Castillo-Reina, M. *Puentes y escaleras como caminos. El "desarrollo" y el capital social en el municipio de Gachantivá en Boyacá, 2020.* (Master's thesis). https://repositorio.uptc.edu.co//handle/001/9660

3. **(2020)**. Ochoa, C., Súarez, L., Suárez, H., Ramírez, E., Valderrama, A., Castillo-Reina M., Castro, H. & Matallana, O. *Efectos y escenarios de recuperación económica frente a la pandemia COVID-19 en Boyacá.* https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.3664379

Non-refereed publications

1. **(2021)**. *Acuerdo Municipal No. 016 de 2021, Por medio del cual se adopta la Política Pública de Ciencia, Tecnología e Innovación del municipio de Tunja 2021 – 2030*.

2. **(2018)**. Vargas, E., Oicatá, R. & Castillo-Reina, M. *Entre las oportunidades y el progreso: la educación superior como camino a la competitividad departamental*. http://bit.ly/EstudioORMET2018

3. **(2018)**. *Ordenanza Número 026 de 2017, por la cual se adopta la Política Pública de Trabajo Decente para el departamento de Boyacá, 2017-2032*.

4. **(2017)**. Pérez, N., Rodríguez, R., Palacios, M., & Castillo-Reina, M. *Determinación del estado actual del Mercado Laboral en el departamento de Boyacá.* http://bit.ly/EstudioORMET2017

Scholarships and Awards

2025	**Full Scholarship (100%),** for Doctoral Studies at Gran Sasso Science Institute (GSSI) (November 2025 - Current)	*Italy*
2018	**Rethinking Economics International Summer Gathering,** Travel Grant	*France*
2018	**Young Scholars Initiative (YSI) from Institute for New Economic Thinking (INET),** Travel Grant	*Argentina*
2017	**Youth Champion,** International Labour Organization (ILO)	*Singapore*
2017	**Partial scholarship (70%),** Master's Program in Economics at the UPTC (2017–2020)	*Colombia*
2015	**Young Scholars Initiative (YSI) from Institute for New Economic Thinking (INET),** Travel Grant	*Chile*
2014	**Full Scholarship (100%),** Academic Assistantship at the UPTC (July 2014 – August 2016)	*Colombia*

Professional and Academic Affiliations

- **Latin American Society for the History of Economic Thought (ALAHPE)** – Member (since 2015) — https://alahpe.org/en/
- **Rethinking Economics** – Member through "ReDe" and the "Economics Student Council, UPTC" (since 2018) — www.rethinkeconomics.org
- **De América Soy** – Co-founder and member (since 2018) — https://deamericasoy.org
- **Centro Regional de Gestión para la Productividad y la Innovación de Boyacá (CREPIB)** – Researcher (since 2016) — www.crepib.org.co

Skills and Interests

Technical Tools	STATA, RStudio, Tableau, MAXQDA, MGA Web, GESPROY, SPGR, SECOP II, Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint)
Languages	Spanish (native). English - C1 (IELTS Academic, 7.0). Italian (beginner)
Interests	Performer and singer of Colombian Tiple and Venezuelan Cuatro. Enthusiast of film and theatre, avid reader, and traveller

References

Available upon request.